popular structured approach called *stakeholder mapping*, or *stakeholder analysis*, to help you make this decision.

DEFINITION According to the ISO 21500 standard, a *stakeholder* is a "person, group, or organization that has interests in, or can affect, be affected by, or perceive itself to be affected by, any aspect of the project." It is crucial to note that even the perception of being affected is enough to be considered a stakeholder and that the perception of being affected can be either positive or negative.

The idea behind stakeholder analysis is to identify stakeholders and their relation to your project so you can strategize how to maximize your positive effect on them and minimize their hindering effect on the project wherever applicable.

This exercise is next to impossible to complete on your own, assuming that you are working in a socio-technically complex environment. Your direct stakeholders and contacts may have other stakeholders and constraints you may not be aware of. Our advice is to use your experience from discussions related to the system landscape diagram and secure help from many people across your organization.

Ruth Murray-Webster and Peter Simon, in "Making Sense of Stakeholder Mapping" (http://mng.bz/aJ2B), propose a stakeholder mapping framework that's perfectly applicable to our needs. It's based on evaluating stakeholders according to three main criteria: power, interest, and attitude, and then mapping their position on axes to create a stakeholder matrix.

The stakeholder's place on the matrix defines their category. Different stakeholder categories have different advised ways of interaction. Let's look at Murray-Webster's and Simon's explanation of the analyzed dimensions:

- *Power* is defined as the ability to direct or influence the organization.

  The middle manager of a team of five has less power in the organization than the C-level executive. However, someone who weekly plays golf with the CEO may have more actual power than that person's position in the organizational chart would suggest. You want to capture the real, not the nominal, power of your stakeholder, if only for your personal use.